TAKE a CRACK

THIS MONTH'S CHALLENGE

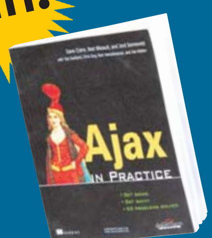
How would you disable and then re-enable the Menu Bar in Windows Explorer?

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to **takeacrack@thinkdigit.com**

Make Explorer's Menu Bar Vanish, Then Re-appear

LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

PC Upgrade & Repair Street Smarts

by Dave Crane, Bear Bibeault and Jord Sonneveld

Published by WILEY-INDIA

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

No One Cracked It ☹

Rules and Regulations

- Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.
- Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.
- Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.
- Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

CORRIGENDUM

The title for last month's *Take A Crack* was "Start And End Processes On A Remote Computer", while the text to the left of the title said "How can you prevent your computer from appearing in Network Neighbourhood?". These do not tally, and they refer to two different problems. The error is regretted.

How can you start and end processes on a remote computer?

Solution To Last Month's Challenge

Windows NT and Windows 2000 Resource Kits come with a number of command-line utilities that let you administer Windows NT/2K/2003/XP/Vista computers. For last month's *Take A Crack*, we require a collection of such tools—known as PsTools—fint it at **http://download.sysinternals.com/Files/PsTools.zip.**

A Resource Kit is a set of software resources and documentation released with or after a major version of Windows. The tools help administrators streamline management tasks such as troubleshooting OS issues, configuring networking and security features, and such.

Before we begin, do note that some anti-virus scanners might report some of the tools contained in the archive you download as infected— specifically, by a "remote admin" virus. None of the PsTools contain any viruses, though. These tools are sometimes used by certain viruses, and therefore trigger the wrong virus notification. Exclude these tools in your anti-virus scanner to disable the warnings.

Extract the tools to a folder. These can be run as standalone programs and don't need installation. The beauty of PsTools is that you don't even need to install any client software on the remote computers at which you target them.

PsTools are interesting and useful; to learn more about them—and to clarify anything you might want to—visit **http://forum.sysinternals.com**.

To start a process on a remote computer, you will require a tool PsExec. This is a lightweight replacement for Telnet that lets you execute processes on other systems, complete with full interactivity for console applications, without having to manually install client software. A simplified usage of this command looks like the following:

```
PsExec \\computer -u username -p password command
```

where

`computer` = The name of the remote computer in UNC format

`username` = An existing username on the remote computer preceding the `-u` switch

`password` = The password associated with the username preceding the `-p` switch

`command` = The command that is to be run remotely

To stop a process on a remote computer, you will need the tool called PsKill. This is a utility that can not only kill processes on the local computer, but can also those on remote systems. Just copy PsKill onto your executable path, and type in `pskill` with the command-line options defined below. A simplified usage of this command looks like

```
PsKill -t \\computer -u username -p password process_id | process_name
```

where

`computer` = The name of the remote computer in UNC format

`username` = An existing username on the remote computer preceding the `-u` switch

`password` = The password associated with the username preceding the `-p` switch

`process_id` = This specifies the process ID of the process you want to kill

`process_name` = This specifies the process name of the process or processes you want to kill

Note here that you can either specify the process ID or the process name of the process you want to kill. If you omit the computer name, PsExec will run the application on the local system, and if you enter a computer name as "*" (without the quotes), PsExec will runs the application on all computers in the current domain.

If you wish, you can create scripts with multiple commands of the above kind to run it simultaneously against many computers. Space does not permit a detailed explanation of the scripting process in this case. ⊠